

Chapter 116_2 - Kiss

The door creaked open again, and someone rushed in in panic. Chu Qingqiu quickly stood up, and when her fingertips loosened, her previously disheveled hair and clothes returned to their proper state.

"Master!" Qiu Yi hurriedly ran to her and half-knelt down, reaching out to take her hands and examine them. "Why do you look so pale? Did that Ning Fuyi bully you?"

"No." Chu Qingqiu shook her head, raising her hand to summon back her white bone weapon, her cheek hidden in her hair. "If I were unwilling, who in this world could bully me?"

Only then did Qiu Yi breathe a sigh of relief. She plopped down and wiped the sweat from her forehead: "That's right. I forgot - Master is so powerful, who could oppress you?"

"But..." Qiu Yi reached toward Chu Qingqiu but didn't dare touch her, putting her hand behind her back.

"In this disciple's heart, Master is the best person in the world. No one can compare to Master, and no one is worthy of Master. So those who dare show even the slightest disrespect to Master - this disciple detests them a thousand times over." Qiu Yi looked up and said.

"Though Master forbids this disciple from mentioning mortal realm matters, having experienced all sorts of things in the mortal realm, this disciple has come to understand some things. Master commands me to inquire everywhere about Ning Fuyi's whereabouts - clearly you care. Master has been moody lately - clearly it's because she's close to others, and you're jealous¹."

"I know Master's affairs are not for me to comment on, but this disciple only wants Master to be happy, which is why I dare to speak up." Qiu Yi said, twisting her fingers together.

Chu Qingqiu touched her swollen lips but didn't restore them to their original state, instead lowering her hand: "You're right, I do care."

"Then why do you keep avoiding her again and again?" Qiu Yi was very puzzled.

"Because..." Chu Qingqiu lowered her head. "I'm afraid."

"Once fear takes root in a person's heart, if this knot isn't untied, they'll never find peace." Chu Qingqiu seemed to have been holding it in for a long time and now spoke truthfully. "I've seen with my own eyes how I caused her tragic death. How can I easily approach her again and make her face danger that could come at any time?"

"I once told Jiang Li about this matter, but I didn't reveal everything." Chu Qingqiu pulled Qiu Yi up from the ground and had her sit beside her. "You're a good child. There are some things I'm afraid I only dare tell you."

Qiu Yi looked confused but still listened carefully.

"Do you know about curse magic?" she asked.

"You taught me before that only in ancient times could those who bore the power of heaven and earth and were born with heaven and earth cast curses." Qiu Yi finished speaking, her expression growing more worried. "It couldn't be..."

"Those curses - Ning Fuyi and I each bear one. Hers is 'a lifetime without love,' and mine is 'unable to cross the trials of emotion'²."

"A lifetime without love' means the world despises her, and no one treats her well. 'Unable to cross the trials of emotion' means that those who love and stay with me must enter the gates of hell."

Qiu Yi's eyes widened, and she nearly fell off the swing.

"You don't need to know why. I was never meant to love anyone, and having already seen her die miserably once, I never again dare to speak lightly of love."

"After all, I can no longer save her."

Chu Qingqiu spoke calmly, but her eyes showed a faint red again. Through the dim underground palace before her, she gazed across time to many years past.

Ning Fuyi no longer needed her protection, and she certainly didn't want her to suffer calamity again.

But having broken free from the Heartless Way³, she could hardly bear the desires in her heart. Now, after being manipulated and tormented by Ning Fuyi in every way, she had stumbled here in confusion.

Qiu Yi found it difficult to express her inner shock. She spent a long time digesting what Chu Qingqiu had said, opening and closing her mouth several times before speaking again.

"But Master, Ning Fuyi doesn't know these things." Qiu Yi bit her lip and continued, "Do you remember what Sister Qi Yunlou told you when you were Su Mo? If you tell her what you just told me, it would surely be a hundred times better than remaining silent now."

"Besides, I heard from Jiuying that Ning Fuyi's recent actions seem to be related to Du Baishuang..."

Chu Qingqiu immediately stood up.

Footnotes

¹ **Jealous (醋意)** - Literally "vinegar feelings," a common Chinese expression for jealousy, as vinegar's sour taste is metaphorically associated with the bitter feeling of jealousy.

² **Unable to cross the trials of emotion (不渡情关)** - A curse that ensures anyone who falls in love with the cursed person will die, preventing them from successfully navigating romantic relationships.

³ **Heartless Way (无情道)** - A cultivation path that requires practitioners to eliminate all emotions and attachments to achieve spiritual advancement. Breaking free from it means regaining the ability to feel emotions.